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c:\>gpg -o example.xls --decrypt example.xls.asc
```

The “-o” parameter specifies the name of the decrypted file to create. Note that you still need to enter the passphrase for your private key. This is only an additional layer of protection on your private key. Without a passphrase, anyone who gains access to your private key would be able to decrypt any messages intended for you.

The weakest link in this process is your private key. If an unauthorized person gets a copy or can guess the passphrase on it, your security will have been breached. So it all boils down to this: Keep your private key secure.